

Story Ambassador Roles & Experience Framework

Two Interns. Shared Mission. Individual Ownership.

A one-year, paid, real-world leadership and community-impact experience designed to prepare emerging leaders for life through responsibility, service, exposure, and hands-on work.

PROGRAM PURPOSE

The Emerging Leaders Internship Program exists to help prepare young men and women for life. MYKNXNS C.D.O. provides the real-world environment in which participants learn by doing: engaging communities, working with leaders, solving problems, managing responsibilities, preserving lived experiences, and helping turn community insight into action.

The objective is not simply to complete assignments. It is to develop capable, confident, thoughtful people who can listen, lead, collaborate, adapt, and contribute wherever life takes them.

HOW THE TWO-INTERN MODEL WORKS

Both Story Ambassadors will be trained toward the same core skill set and will receive exposure to the same major areas of work. They may, however, take primary ownership of different initiatives, cities, projects, partner relationships, events, or deliverables based on program needs, individual strengths, development goals, and workload. Cross-training ensures that neither role becomes a silo and that both interns can support one another when needed.

TERM	START	TIME	COMPENSATION
One-year commitment	Onboarding begins Nov. 2026	Approx. 15–20 hours/week	\$20/hour

Activity-by-Activity Responsibility Framework

The following framework defines the work both interns will learn and perform. “Primary ownership” may rotate or be assigned by initiative; “cross-trained support” means the second intern understands the work and can contribute or step in.

1. Community Research & Preparation

- Research each community before engagement, including nonprofits, universities and HBCUs, museums, Black chambers, veteran organizations, faith organizations, businesses, sponsors, media, government agencies, and existing community initiatives.
- Identify community priorities, potential partners, service opportunities, major events, local leaders, and areas where MYKNXNS C.D.O. may be able to contribute.
- Prepare city/community briefs, stakeholder lists, background notes, talking points, interview research, and pre-meeting materials.
- Verify names, dates, organizations, images, links, locations, and other public-facing details before use.

Skills developed: Research, critical thinking, curiosity, community awareness, attention to detail, organization

2. Community Engagement & Listening

- Participate in and increasingly help lead listening sessions, community meetings, town halls, partner conversations, and public activations.
- Engage directly with residents, elders, families, young people, small-business owners, veterans, educators, faith leaders, and other community voices.
- Ask thoughtful questions, document what is heard, identify recurring needs and opportunities, and capture follow-up commitments.
- Help create a welcoming, respectful environment in which community members feel heard and valued.

Skills developed: Active listening, communication, confidence, facilitation, empathy, relationship-building

3. Government & Civic Engagement

- Support outreach to local, city, county, and state government officials and relevant public agencies.
- Schedule and participate in meetings with elected officials, staff, community-development offices, veteran agencies, arts/culture offices, education partners, and other civic stakeholders.
- Prepare meeting briefs, questions, notes, action items, and follow-up correspondence.
- Represent MYKNXNS C.D.O. professionally and help identify ways public institutions and the organization can support community priorities.

Skills developed: Professional communication, civic awareness, preparation, public speaking, judgment, follow-through

4. Partnership Development & Relationship Management

- Conduct outreach to nonprofits, schools, universities/HBCUs, museums, Black chambers, faith organizations, veteran organizations, businesses, sponsors, donors, media, and other prospective partners.
- Help schedule introductory conversations and partner meetings and participate in those conversations.
- Maintain stakeholder/contact trackers, meeting notes, commitments, next steps, and follow-up dates.
- Help move relationships from introduction to meaningful collaboration, including referrals and introductions across local networks.

Skills developed: Networking, relationship management, professional writing, collaboration, stakeholder management

5. Story Identification, Preparation & Preservation

- Help identify people whose stories, wisdom, experiences, traditions, and perspectives should be preserved.

- Research interview subjects and help prepare interview questions, story prompts, background notes, releases, and schedules.
- Support story capture through interviews, photography, video, audio, notes, and other approved formats.
- Help organize, label, document, and preserve story assets and ensure information is handled respectfully and accurately.

Skills developed: Interviewing, storytelling, listening, research, documentation, cultural sensitivity, digital organization

6. Legacy Tour Planning & On-Site Execution

- Support planning for Legacy Tour stops, including outreach, schedules, venues, community partners, volunteers, film crews, materials, transportation, and follow-up.
- Help coordinate site logistics and community activations before arrival.
- Serve as visible Story Ambassadors on-site: welcome participants, engage residents, support partners, coordinate volunteers, help manage activities, and solve problems as they arise.
- Document issues, commitments, lessons, and follow-up actions after each activation.

Skills developed: Project management, event execution, adaptability, problem-solving, teamwork, accountability

7. Community Initiatives: From Insight to Action

- Help synthesize what is learned from community stories, listening sessions, partner conversations, research, and lived experiences.
- Identify themes, needs, assets, and opportunities that can inform community initiatives.
- Work with residents, organizations, leaders, and the MYKNXNS C.D.O. team to help shape initiatives aligned with outcomes the community wants to achieve.
- Support planning, outreach, partnerships, volunteer mobilization, and implementation of approved initiatives.

Skills developed: Strategic thinking, co-creation, problem-solving, initiative design, collaboration, execution

8. Impact Measurement, Evaluation & Continuous Improvement

- Help define what success should look like for specific activities and initiatives before work begins.
- Track participation, outputs, commitments, stories preserved, partnerships, volunteer activity, community feedback, and other relevant measures.
- Gather qualitative feedback from residents, partners, participants, and team members.
- Compare intended outcomes with actual results, identify what worked and what did not, document lessons learned, and recommend improvements.
- Help turn those lessons into better future activations, initiatives, processes, and community partnerships.

Skills developed: Impact measurement, analytical thinking, reflection, feedback, learning, continuous improvement

9. Communications, Media & Public Representation

- Support development and proofreading of community updates, event materials, partner communications, social/digital content, and other approved materials.
- Assist with local media coordination, interview preparation, event promotion, and content capture when appropriate.
- Represent MYKNXNS C.D.O. at meetings, events, activations, and community gatherings.
- Learn to communicate appropriately with different audiences while protecting participant dignity, privacy, and trust.

Skills developed: Writing, public speaking, audience awareness, media readiness, professionalism, judgment

10. Business, Budgeting & Resource Management

- Gain exposure to how activities and initiatives are budgeted, resourced, and prioritized.
- Help develop or maintain simple project/event budgets, cost estimates, purchasing lists, and resource trackers as assigned.
- Compare planned versus actual needs/costs and help identify practical tradeoffs and solutions.

- Support responsible use of program resources and documentation of approved expenses or in-kind support when applicable.

Skills developed: Budgeting, financial literacy, resource management, decision-making, business fundamentals

11. Operations, Organization & Follow-Through

- Maintain assigned project plans, task lists, calendars, trackers, shared files, meeting notes, and follow-up lists.
- Prepare agendas, call sheets, briefing documents, contact lists, and other operating materials.
- Track deadlines and commitments and communicate early when something is at risk.
- Help ensure work moves from idea to action to completion rather than stopping at discussion.

Skills developed: Organization, time management, prioritization, reliability, project management, follow-through

12. Ad Hoc Projects & Emerging Opportunities

- Take on additional assignments that arise from community needs, Legacy Tour activities, partnerships, organizational priorities, or unexpected opportunities.
- Examples may include special research, new community projects, event support, donor/sponsor preparation, presentations, process improvement, technology/AI-enabled work, or time-sensitive outreach.
- Ad hoc work will be assigned with clear expectations and should reinforce the program's learning, service, and leadership objectives.

Skills developed: Adaptability, initiative, learning agility, problem-solving, ownership

How Work Will Be Assigned Between the Two Interns

The program is intentionally designed around shared learning and individual ownership. The interns are not intended to become “Intern A = one permanent function” and “Intern B = another permanent function.” Instead, both will learn the full operating model while taking turns owning meaningful work.

WORKING MODEL	PRIMARY INTERN	CROSS-TRAINED INTERN
Assigned initiative / project	Owns planning, deadlines, coordination, deliverables, status updates, and follow-through.	Learns the work, supports execution, provides a second perspective, and can step in when needed.
Community / city assignment	May serve as primary point person for designated partners, research, meetings, and follow-up.	Participates in selected meetings/activities and remains familiar with the city or initiative.
Event / activation	May lead a workstream such as volunteers, partner coordination, story capture, logistics, or participant experience.	Supports another workstream and rotates responsibilities across events.
Community initiative	May coordinate the initiative from insight through implementation and evaluation.	Supports research, partner engagement, measurement, and execution; learns the full initiative cycle.
Special / ad hoc work	May be assigned based on urgency, strengths, development needs, or availability.	Supports as needed and is cross-trained where the work is likely to recur.

Shared Expectations

- Come prepared, ask questions, and communicate clearly.
- Take ownership of assigned work and follow through on commitments.
- Bring ideas to the table rather than waiting only for assignments.
- Listen before acting, particularly when working with communities.
- Treat residents, partners, stories, data, and relationships with respect.
- Support one another and share knowledge rather than creating silos.
- Be willing to receive feedback, reflect on performance, and improve.
- Escalate concerns early when safety, ethics, privacy, deadlines, budgets, or community trust may be affected.
- Represent MYKNXNS C.D.O. professionally in person, online, and in written communication.

What Success Looks Like

At the end of the experience, success should be visible in both community outcomes and participant growth.

- Communities were engaged respectfully and their priorities informed the work.
- Stories, wisdom, experiences, and perspectives were preserved and used to deepen understanding.
- Community insight helped shape initiatives designed to advance outcomes residents and partners value.
- Partnerships were built and strengthened across community, civic, education, faith, veteran, business, donor/sponsor, and other networks.
- Initiatives and activations were implemented, measured, evaluated, and improved based on what was learned.
- Each intern can point to projects they owned, problems they helped solve, relationships they built, and work that mattered.

- Both interns leave with a broader, transferable skill set and greater confidence, judgment, accountability, and readiness for what comes next.

WHY THIS MATTERS TO PARTNERS, SPONSORS & DONORS

Support for the Emerging Leaders Internship Program invests in two outcomes at once: stronger communities and stronger emerging leaders. Participants gain real-world experience by working alongside communities—not merely behind the scenes—while helping MYKNXNS C.D.O. listen, preserve what matters, build partnerships, translate insight into initiatives, and learn from results.

Preserve Connections. Protect Legacy. Empower Generations.